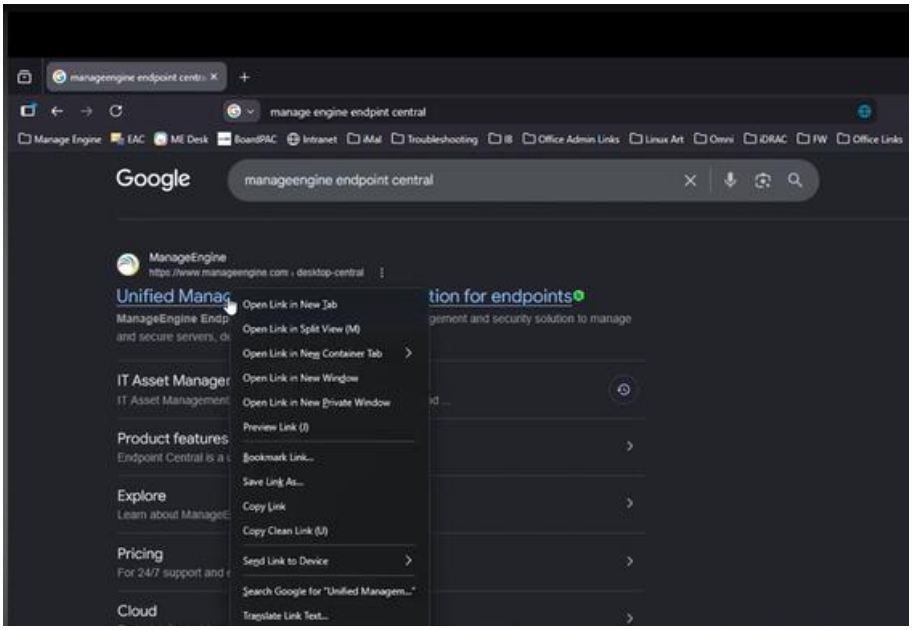
Part 05 – Bonus Tool: Installing ManageEngine Endpoint Central

In addition to SQL Server administration tasks, this lab also covers, as a bonus, how to install a Unified Endpoint Management (UEM) tool called "ManageEngine Endpoint Central," which helps manage an entire IT infrastructure. This is a tool widely used by IT administrators for tasks such as patch management, asset inventory, remote troubleshooting, and software deployment — knowledge of such IT infrastructure management tools is a valuable addition alongside SQL Server administration skills.

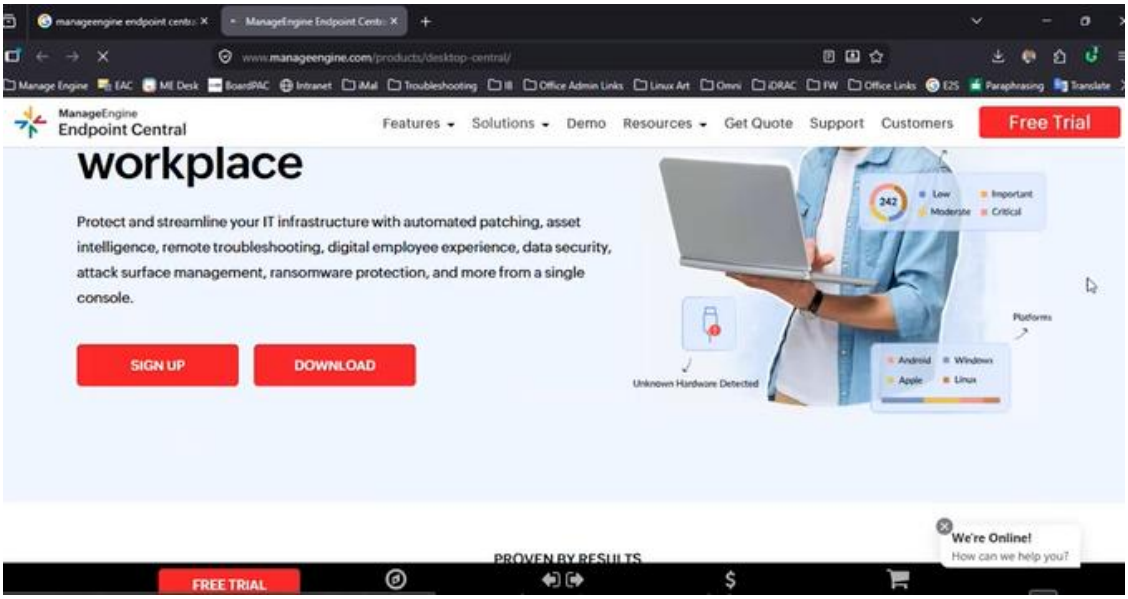
5.1 Searching for ManageEngine Endpoint Central



Google Search – ManageEngine Endpoint Central

Searching Google for "manageengine endpoint central" to reach the official product/download page. (As a good security habit, always download installer files from the vendor's official domain — manageengine.com — and avoid third-party sites that may contain malware.)

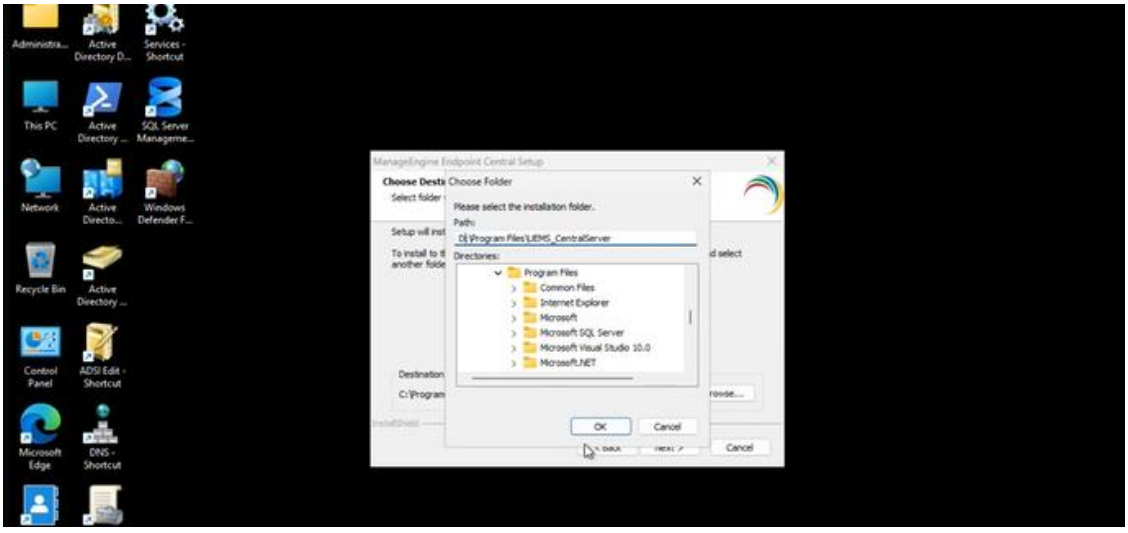
5.2 Official Product Page



ManageEngine Endpoint Central – official website

On the ManageEngine Endpoint Central homepage, you can see its key features — Automated Patching, Asset Intelligence, Remote Troubleshooting, Digital Employee Experience, Data Security, Attack Surface Management, and Ransomware Protection — all managed from a single console, across platforms including Windows, Android, Apple, and Linux. The installer can be obtained via the "Free Trial" or "Download" button.

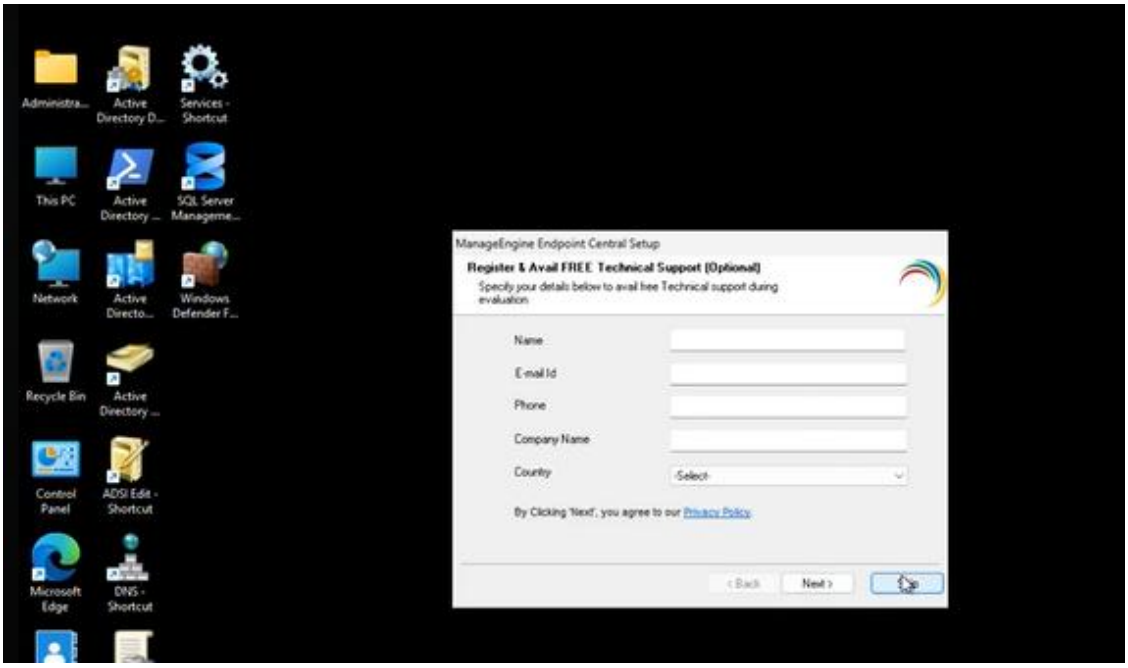
5.3 Choosing the Destination Folder for Installation



ManageEngine Endpoint Central Setup – Choose Destination Folder

The installer asks for the path of the folder to install into. Here too, following the same policy applied earlier for SQL Server/SSMS in Part 02, the installation path has been changed from the default C: drive location to a "UEMS_CentralServer" folder on the D: drive — the practice of keeping application data separate from the OS drive continues here as well.

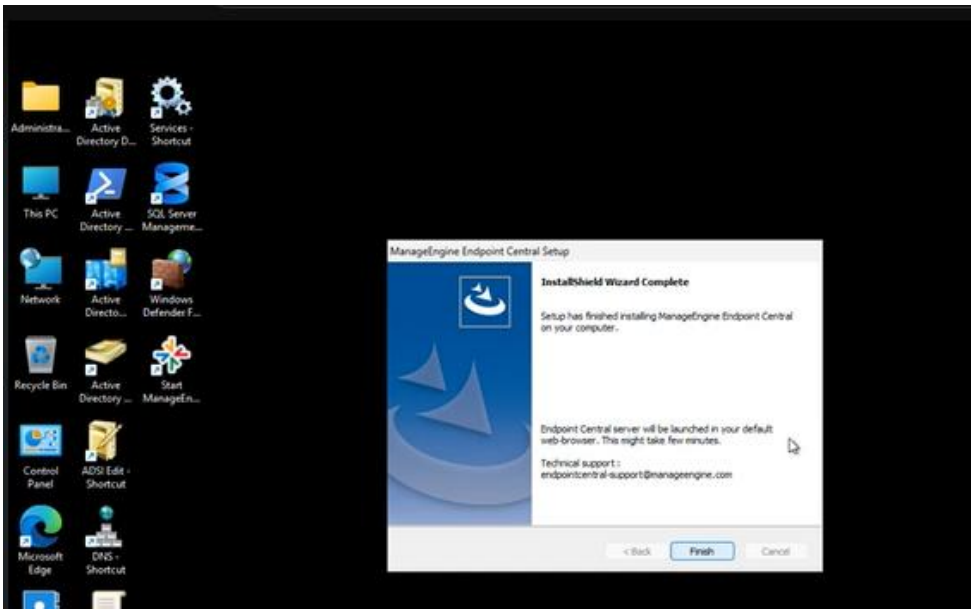
5.4 Skipping the Optional Technical Support Registration



ManageEngine Endpoint Central Setup – Register for Support (Optional)

During installation, an optional form titled "Register & Avail FREE Technical Support" is shown, asking for details such as Name, Email, Phone, Company Name, and Country. This is not required to complete the installation — it only relates to enrolling with vendor support — so it has been "Skipped" in this lab before proceeding.

5.5 Installation Complete

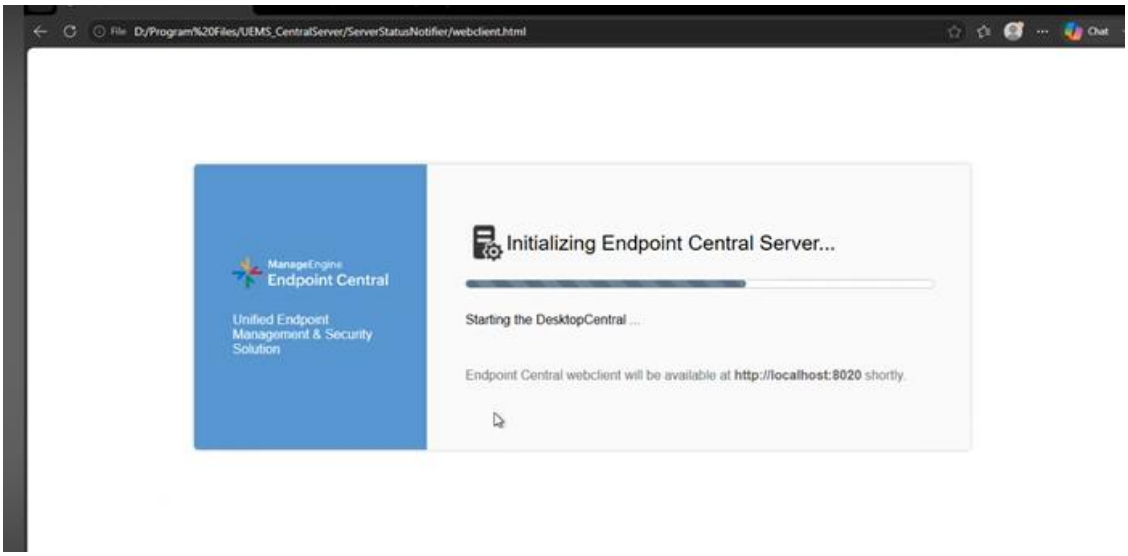


InstallShield Wizard Complete

The message "InstallShield Wizard Complete" confirms that the ManageEngine Endpoint Central installation finished successfully. A note also states, "Endpoint Central server will be launched in your

default web browser. This might take a few minutes" — meaning it will take some time for the server to initialize after installation.

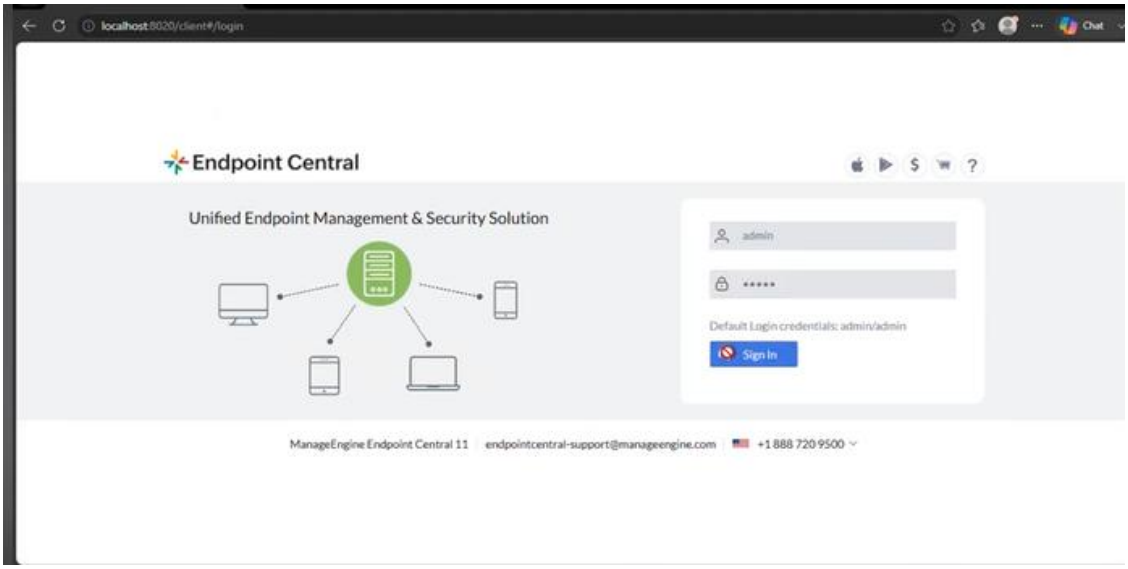
5.6 Endpoint Central Server Starting Up



Endpoint Central Server – Initializing

After installation, a local HTML status page (D:\Program Files\UEMS_CentralServer\ServerStatusNotifier\webclient.html) opens automatically, showing "Initializing Endpoint Central Server..." and "Starting the DesktopCentral..." as the background services start up. Since its internal database and services are all being set up for the first time, this can take a few minutes — the web console eventually becomes accessible via "http://localhost:8020".

5.7 Login Page

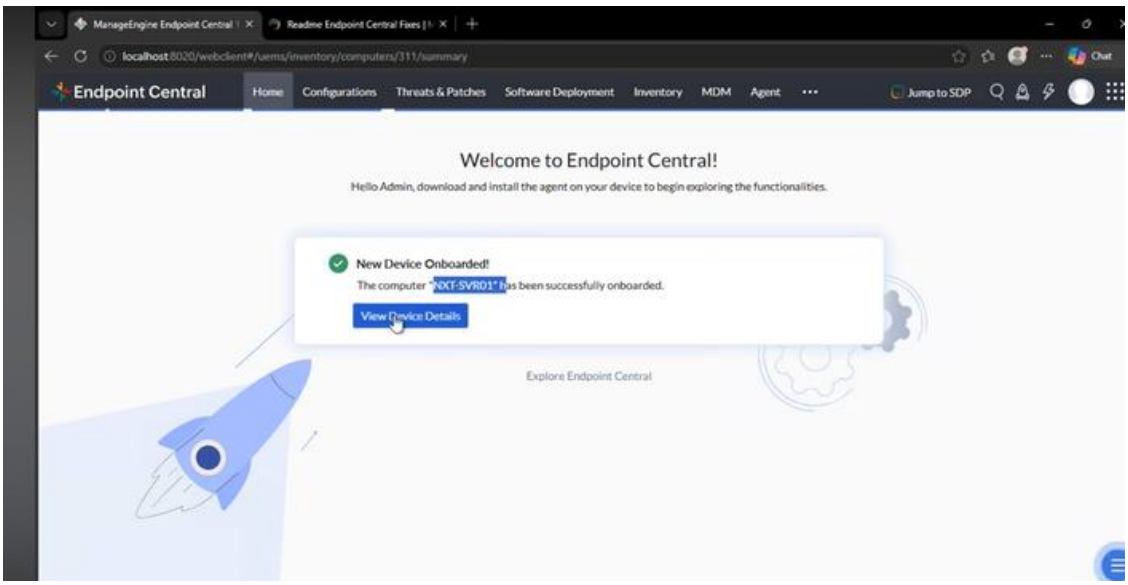


Endpoint Central – Login Page (localhost:8020)

Once the server has fully initialized, the browser automatically navigates to "http://localhost:8020/client#/login". The default login credentials, username "admin" and password "admin," are shown — these are intended only for testing/demo purposes.

> *Security warning: in any real/production deployment, this default password ("admin") must be changed immediately after the first login. Leaving default credentials unchanged is one of the most common and dangerous security risks in any system.*

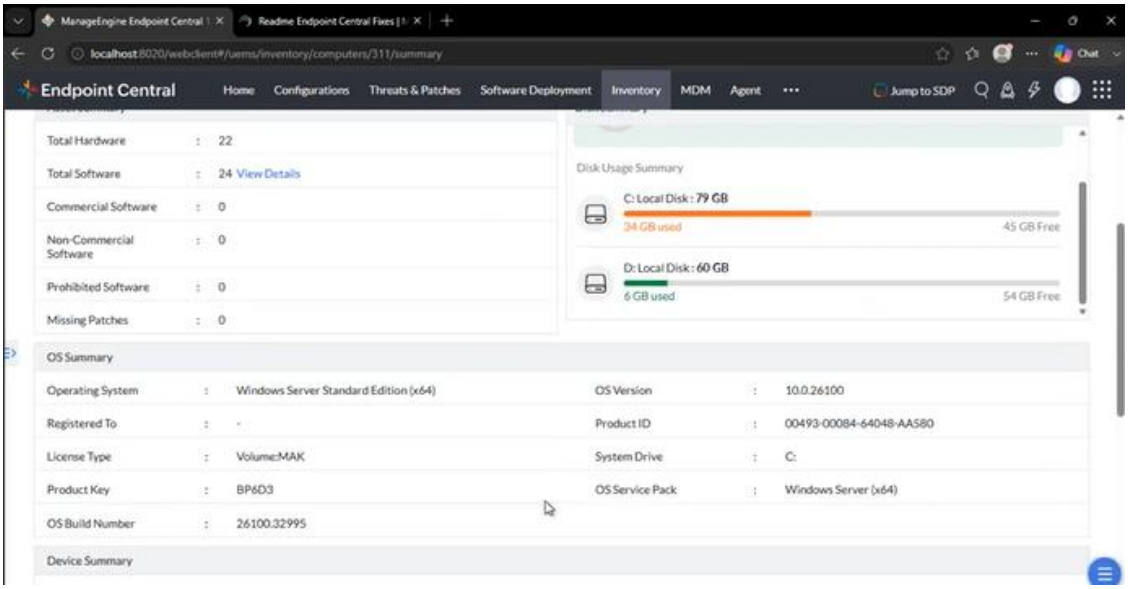
5.8 After the First Login — the Device Is Automatically Onboarded



Endpoint Central Dashboard – New Device Onboarded

After logging in, the "Welcome to Endpoint Central!" dashboard is shown. Since the Endpoint Central agent was also installed alongside the server on which it was installed (NXT-SVR01), that server has automatically been onboarded as the first "Managed Device," confirmed by the message "New Device Onboarded!" The "View Device Details" link leads to that device's full details.

5.9 Viewing Device Inventory Details



Endpoint Central – Inventory Summary

Under "View Device Details" → "Inventory" tab, you can see detailed data automatically collected by Endpoint Central about the server — Total Hardware/Software counts, the number of Commercial/Non-Commercial software items, the number of Missing Patches, Disk Usage on both the C: and D: drives (used/free space), and OS Summary details (Operating System, OS Version/Build, Product Key, License Type, System Drive). This kind of automated asset inventory data is extremely useful for the "Monitoring and Performance Tuning" and "Capacity Planning" tasks discussed in section 1.9 ("Preparation and Planning") — how much of a server's resources are being used, and what its patch compliance status is, can be checked instantly at any moment.

WAMP Server — A Suggestion for Further Self-Study

At the end of the lab practical, "WAMP Server" is suggested as a topic for further self-study. WAMP (Windows, Apache, MySQL, PHP) is a free local web server software bundle for Windows that allows web applications built on PHP and MySQL to be developed and tested locally, before being deployed to a live server. None of the screenshots in this lab cover WAMP, and we suggest covering it separately as a future chapter.

Cyber Security

1. Core Concepts

1.1 Vulnerability

A vulnerability is a weakness in an asset — a system, application, or network — that a threat actor can exploit. Four common reasons behind the existence of vulnerabilities:

1. Hardware or software misconfiguration — something set up incorrectly, such as default passwords left unchanged or wrong firewall rules.
2. Insecure or poor design of the network and application — the system was never built with security in mind.
3. Inherent technology weaknesses — flaws built into the technology itself, such as an old protocol with no encryption.
4. Careless approach of end users — people clicking phishing links, reusing passwords, etc.

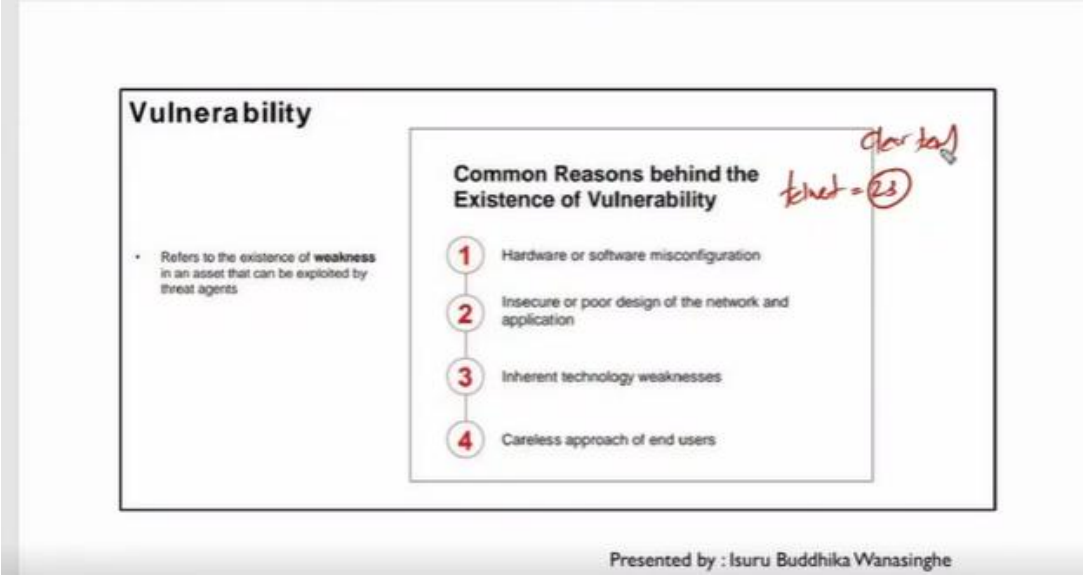


Fig. 1 — Vulnerability and its common causes

1.2 Motives, Goals, and Objectives of an Attack

Key formula: Attacks = Motive (Goal) + Method + Vulnerability.

A motive originates from the belief that the target system stores or processes something valuable, which creates the threat of an attack. Attackers then use various tools and techniques to exploit vulnerabilities in a system or its security controls in order to achieve that motive.

Common motives behind information security attacks include:

- Disrupting business continuity
- Information theft and manipulating data
- Creating fear and chaos by disrupting critical infrastructure

- Causing financial loss to the target
- Propagating religious or political beliefs
- Achieving a state's military objectives
- Damaging the reputation of the target
- Taking revenge
- Demanding ransom



Fig. 2 — Motives, goals, and objectives of an information security attack

1.3 The Five Phases of Hacking

This is the classic penetration-testing / ethical-hacking lifecycle used across the industry (e.g. CEH):

5. Reconnaissance — gathering information about the target before attacking (passive or active information gathering).
6. Scanning — actively probing the target to find live hosts, open ports, and running services (tools such as nmap are used here).
7. Gaining Access — exploiting a discovered vulnerability to break into the system.
8. Maintaining Access — keeping a foothold in the system, e.g. through backdoors or persistence mechanisms, so the attacker can return later.
9. Clearing Tracks — deleting logs and evidence to avoid detection.